

Facebook app for WP

After being updated, this brings Windows Phone at par with Android and iOS apps

Call details for prepaid users

Vodafone has started MyAccount services for Prepaid users with complete call details

App Watch

desktop OS, critically “most of the code”. This will help developers port Windows 8 apps on to Windows Phone 8, particularly on tablet devices. At the time of writing, we were getting conflicting reports, some suggesting that this kernel sharing may not happen. Safe to wait on that one! The current Windows Phone 7 has the same kernel as Windows CE. The Metro UI will be very similar on the two OSes. Zune desktop will make way for a more streamlined application for syncing data to and from the phone. SkyDrive will have deeper integration – all your documents and media will be instantly available on your new phone. Skype has been integrated into the OS, allowing for VOIP calls to be made in a way similar to non-VOIP calls.

On the way is the removable storage feature for microSD cards. At the moment, Windows Phone 7 needs to format the external storage before it can be read.

We think

If the kernel-sharing thing goes ahead, the sheer number of apps ported across the two platforms will be tremendous. It will give WP 8 a huge advantage in catching up with Android and iOS in terms of app store population. And hopefully a smoother sharing experience between the desktop and smartphone, with the likes of SkyDrive, Office etc.

Secure for business

With one eye on getting a chunk of the BlackBerry

market, the new OS will come with 128-bit full-disk encryption, similar to the one we see on higher-end versions of Windows 7 PC OS at the moment.

We think

Microsoft wants to call up all the Windows Phone 6.5 Professional users (who have now surely moved on to BlackBerry, iOS and Android) and probably meet up for coffee!

Managing data

While this feature has been around in most other smartphone OSes for a while, WP8 will offer data usage monitors. A live tile will allow a one-glance check. While this feature may not be available in India, the new OS will

automatically connect to cellular network operated Wi-Fi networks.

We Think

Nothing new. iOS and Android already have apps that do this. But this is a step in the right direction.

At the moment, it isn't clear when exactly this version of the OS is coming. However, we expect it to be not soon after the Windows 8 official release sometime in October. It's safe to say that you'll have Windows Phone 8 smartphones in the global markets by the end of 2012. And this shouldn't be confused with Windows Phone Tango, an update for the current Windows Phone 7 OS. 

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